

5.5 Proxies And Internet Sharing

Proxies are a great way of sharing Internet bandwidth. Multiple users can access the same Internet connection through one IP. This works wonderfully in a home environment setting where bandwidth is limited as are the number of users.

Proxy servers can dramatically increase speeds of these connections either by timesharing or by pre-allocating bandwidths. A proxy server keeps a temporary file of a previously visited site, and if that site is requested again, it provides the data from those temporary files. This optimises speed and saves resources.

Most proxy servers keep track of the most-visited Web sites and have a directory of access as well. Ideally, the proxy server should be on the same network as the users, which results in faster operation.

Proxy servers are a great way of controlling what type of information comes into and goes out of the network. Certain types of content can be easily blocked through a proxy connection as well. This not only ensures that only the most suitable content is accessed, but also saves on bandwidth by blocking out Flash or ActiveX content, which, in some cases, could be malicious.

WinProxy 5.2a

Winproxy is one of the most efficient proxy servers and enables you to connect various computers connected together to the Internet simultaneously. It is pre-loaded with a firewall and NAT. It also features a stealth firewall, server Anti-Virus, site filtering, site caching, customisable alerting, user controls and even a VPN client. However, setting up the proxies can be a complex task, as creating accounts needs a few verifications which may require changing of network settings.

The interface is complex, but not as complex as some of the other software we tested in this category. However, managing proxies seems to be much easier than creating them. The admin